UNIVERSITY INTERSCHOLASTIC LEAGUE

Making a World of Difference

Literary Criticism

District 1 • 2011



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University Interscholastic League
Literary Criticism Contest • District 1 • 2011

Part 1: Knowledge of Literary Terms and of Literary History **30 items (1 point each)**

1. The metrical pattern that exhibits a foot consisting of an unstressed syllable followed by a stressed syllable and that is repeated four times per line is

   A) iambic pentameter.
   B) iambic tetrameter.
   C) spondaic tetrameter.
   D) trochaic pentameter.
   E) trochaic tetrameter.

2. A composition, usually verse, arranged in such a way that it spells words, phrases, or sentences when certain letters are selected according to an orderly sequence is an

   A) abecedarius.
   B) acrostic.
   C) anagram.
   D) ananym.
   E) aphorism.

3. The twentieth-century American author whose works include *Intruder in the Dust*, *The Reivers*, *The Sound and the Fury*, and *Light in August*, is

   A) William Faulkner.
   B) Norman Mailer.
   C) Philip Roth.
   D) John Steinbeck.
   E) John Updike.

4. A figure of speech in which the literal sense of what is said falls detectably short of the magnitude of what is being talked about is a(n)

   A) ambiguity.
   B) amphiboly.
   C) demotion.
   D) litotes.
   E) understatement.

5. Originally a writing about a saint, now a biography that praises the virtues of its subject, is known as a(n)

   A) canticle.
   B) epistolary.
   C) hagiography.
   D) lampoon.
   E) miracle play.

6. A term applied to any person who through contrast underscores the distinctive characteristics of another person is

   A) foil.
   B) nemesis.
   C) persona.
   D) regisseur.
   E) tritagonist.

7. An intensified form of the revenge tragedy made popular on the Elizabethan stage by Thomas Kyd's *Spanish Tragedy* and emulated in Shakespeare's *Hamlet* is (the)

   A) requiem.
   B) *Sturm und Drang*.
   C) theatrum mundi.
   D) tragedy of blood.
   E) turpiloquium.

8. The playwright who died the night before the first public performance of his Pulitzer Prize-winning *Rent* (1996) is

   A) Edward Albee.
   B) Jonathan Larson.
   C) David Mamet.
   D) Neil Simon.
   E) Alfred Uhry.

9. A term originally applied to painting and now used in the criticism of various literary forms involving the contrast of light and darkness is

   A) charade.
   B) chiaroscuro.
   C) chiasmus.
   D) chrestomathy.
   E) chronotope.

10. Not among the works of the twentieth-century American playwright Eugene O'Neill is

    A) *Anna Christie*.
    B) *Death of a Salesman*.
    C) *The Iceman Cometh*.
    D) *Long Day's Journey into Night*.
    E) *Strange Interlude*.

11. A cultural artifact that might or might not be words, might or might not be written down, and that is typically characterized by imagination, emotion, significant meaning, and sense impressions, as well as concrete language that invites attention to its own physical features (such as sound and appearance on the page) is generally agreed to be a(n)

A) *carmen figuratum*.
B) kenning.
C) obelisk.
D) poem.
E) wiki.

12. Not among the many literary works Oscar Wilde left us to enjoy is

A) *The Ballad of Reading Gaol*.
B) *The Importance of Being Earnest*.
C) *Lady Windermere's Fan*.
D) *The Picture of Dorian Gray*.
E) *The Portrait of a Lady*.

13. In modern use, any poem about rural people and setting that adheres to the genre's original sense and includes "shepherds" of some kind is a

A) *chanson de geste*.
B) jeremiad.
C) madrigal.
D) pastoral.
E) vision.

14. The American author who moved to rural Florida where she wrote short stories and novels about the rural life including *The Yearling*, for which she won the 1939 Pulitzer Prize for Fiction, is

A) Geraldine Brooks.
B) Shirley Ann Grau.
C) Alison Lurie.
D) E. Annie Proulx.
E) Marjorie Kinnan Rawlings.

15. A rhetorical disposition applied to a statement or situation to shape its reception and interpretation, most frequently applied to political rhetoric, is

A) bathos.
B) ethos.
C) flosculation.
D) pathos.
E) spin.

16. The period in English literary history that begins with the First World War and encompasses the Second World War and its aftermath and that is characterized by influential English-language novelists, poets, and playwrights who, while citizens of the British Commonwealth, are not actually English is the

A) Modernist Period in English Literature.
B) Period of the Confessional Self.
C) Post-Modernist or Contemporary Period.
D) Realistic Period.
E) Romantic Period.

17. A self-contradictory combination of words or smaller verbal units is a(n)

A) hyperbole.
B) litotes.
C) mimesis.
D) oxymoron.
E) paradox.

18. The trope in which occurs a substitution of the name of an object closely associated with a word for the word itself is

A) ambiguity.
B) hypallage.
C) metonymy.
D) onomatopoeia.
E) synecdoche.

19. A work of fiction, a major concern of which is the nature of fiction itself, such as John Barth's *Lost in the Funhouse* and John Fowles's *The French Lieutenant's Woman*, is known as

A) epistolary novel.
B) framework-story.
C) metafiction.
D) objective correlative.
E) palimpsest.

20. The Chilean poet, aspirant to the Chilean presidency, and recipient of the 1971 Nobel Prize for Literature is

A) Vicente Aleixandre.
B) Camilo José Cela.
C) Nilo Cruz.
D) Gabriel García Márquez.
E) Pablo Neruda.

21. The movement affecting painting and literature, including drama, that attempts to objectify inner experience and through which external objects are understood as transmitters of internal impressions and moods is

A) aestheticism.
B) expressionism.
C) minimalism.
D) objectivism.
E) vorticism.

22. One or more words repeated at intervals in a poem, usually at the end of a stanza, is called a(n)

A) anaphora.
B) ballad.
C) pantoum.
D) refrain.
E) stanza.

23. The group of writers, including F. Scott Fitzgerald, Erich Maria Remarque, and Ernest Hemingway, who were born around 1900, some serving in WWI, and who also reacted against certain tendencies of older writers in the 1920s is known as the

A) Agrarians.
B) Fugitives.
C) Hartford Wits.
D) Lost Generation.
E) Pre-Raphaelites.

24. The term often applied to the Neoclassic Period in English literature and sometimes to the Revolutionary and Early National Period in American literature because both periods emphasized rationalism, self-knowledge, and rule of law is the

A) Age of Reason.
B) Commonwealth Interregnum.
C) Naturalistic and Symbolistic Period.
D) Period of Modernism and Consolidation.
E) Restoration Age.

25. The American poet who received the 1994 Pulitzer Prize for Poetry for his *Neon Vernacular* and who sees poetry as a "kind of distilled insinuation" is

A) Carl Dennis.
B) Yusef Komunyakaa.
C) Philip Levine.
D) Mark Strand.
E) Charles Wright.

26. The variety of folk song developed in the southern United States at the end of the nineteenth century that is characterized by melancholy, repetition, and being sung slowly in a minor mode is known as

A) blues.
B) calypso.
C) rap.
D) reggae.
E) scat.

27. Not a type of funeral song or poetic lamentation is the

A) coronach.
B) dirge.
C) eulogy.
D) monody.
E) threnody.

28. The critical approach based on psychological speculations and discoveries that argues the influence of the unconscious and that has offered a new light on character relationships in literary works is

A) absolutist criticism.
B) feminist criticism.
C) Freudian criticism.
D) historical criticism.
E) Marxist criticism.

29. The nineteenth-century British author whose novels of manners include *Shirley* and *Villette* and who wrote her most famous work, *Jane Eyre*, under the gender-ambiguous nom de plume Currer Bell is

A) Charlotte Brontë.
B) Emily Brontë.
C) Elizabeth Barrett Browning.
D) Mary Ann Evans.
E) Christina Rossetti.

30. A genre that embodies the characteristics of a medieval Icelandic narrative of heroic achievement or adventure is the

A) *art brut*.
B) chronicle.
C) epic.
D) legend.
E) saga.

Part 2: The UIL Reading List **20 items (2 points each)**

Items 31-36 are associated with Eugene O'Neill's *The Hairy Ape*.
Items 37-43 are associated with Jane Austen's *Pride and Prejudice*.
Items 44-50 are associated with Theodore Roethke's poetry (selected).

31. In O'Neill's *Hairy Ape* Yank responds to Long's comment on all men being equal with the rhetorical question "What's dem slobs in de foist cabin got to do wit us?" which points to a distinction regarding
    A) constitutional law.
    B) political views.
    C) social classes.
    D) stokers and officers.
    E) travel accommodations.

32. While raging in the prison cell, one of the Voices suggests that in order for Yank to get back at the "gang she runs wit," Yank should join the
    A) Black Hand.
    B) Elks.
    C) Secret Service.
    D) Wobblies.
    E) zoological society.

33. In his recalling something of his youth, Yank remembers that his parents never went to church, that they "[a]lways got too big a head on Sunday mornin'"; indeed, Yank recounts that his mother died from
    A) delirium tremens.
    B) head trauma.
    C) lung cancer.
    D) spousal abuse.
    E) tuberculosis.

34. "I'm a waste product in the Bessemer process—like the millions" is a self-description offered by
    A) Harp.
    B) Long.
    C) Mildred.
    D) Paddy.
    E) Yank.

35. Paddy, often given to philosophy, declares that it would take a wise man to tell the difference between
    A) apes and men.
    B) love and hate.
    C) money and class.
    D) whiskey and beer.
    E) women and trouble.

36. Yank's cynical response to the Policeman's question "What have you been doin'? after being found alone sitting in the middle of the street includes an admission of guilt for being
    A) born.
    B) drunk.
    C) lost.
    D) rude.
    E) threatening.

37. In Jane Austen's *Pride and Prejudice*, a "plan of amends—of atonement—for inheriting [the] father's estate" drives
    A) Mr. Bennet.
    B) Mr. Bingley.
    C) Mr. Collins.
    D) Mr. Darcy.
    E) Mr. Wickham.

38. "I am only resolved to act in that manner, which will, in my own opinion, constitute my happiness, without reference to *you*, or any person so wholly unconnected to me" is declared by
    A) Elizabeth to Mr. Bennet.
    B) Elizabeth to Mrs. Bennet.
    C) Elizabeth to Lady Catherine.
    D) Elizabeth to Mr. Collins.
    E) Elizabeth to Mr. Darcy.

39. Netherfield Park, Longbourn, and Pemberley are primarily associated with, respectively,
    A) the Bennets, the Bingleys, and the Darcys.
    B) the Bennets, the Darcys, and the Bingleys.
    C) the Bingleys, the Bennets, and the Darcys.
    D) the Darcys, the Bennets, and the Bingleys.
    E) the Darcys, the Bingleys, and the Bennets.

40. The famous Scottish destination to which it was rumored that Lydia and Wickham had eloped is
    A) Aberdeen.
    B) Dundee.
    C) Edinburgh.
    D) Glasgow.
    E) Gretna Green.

41. The self-assessment underlying the question "[H]ow can I promise to be wiser than so many of my fellow creatures if I am tempted, or how am I even to know that it would be wisdom to resist?" suggests something of the dynamic character of

A) Charlotte.
B) Georgianna.
C) Jane.
D) Lizzy.
E) Lydia.

42. Mr. Darcy's response to Miss Bingley, "A lady's imagination is very rapid; it jumps from admiration to love, from love to matrimony in a moment," follows Caroline's discovery that Fitzwilliam is interested in

A) Elizabeth.
B) Jane.
C) Kitty.
D) Lydia.
E) Mary.

43. Austen's narrator tells us that "Elizabeth suspected herself to be the first creature who had ever dared to trifle with so much dignified impertinence"; the person astonished by Elizabeth's attitude is

A) Lady Catherine de Bourgh.
B) Lady Anne Darcy.
C) Lady Lucas.
D) Sir William Lucas.
E) Lady Metcalfe.

Items 44-50 refer to Theodore Roethke's

Open House

My secrets cry aloud.
I have no need for tongue.
My heart keeps open house,
My doors are widely swung.
An epic of the eyes
My love, with no disguise.

My truths are all foreknown,
This anguish self-revealed.
I'm naked to the bone,
With nakedness my shield.
Myself is what I wear:
I keep the spirit spare.
The anger will endure,
The deed will speak the truth
In language strict and pure.
I stop the lying mouth;
Rage warps my clearest cry
To witness agony.

44. Roethke's use of *tongue* in line 2 of "Open House" is an example of

A) gustatory imagery.
B) metaphor.
C) metonymy.
D) onomatopoeia.
E) simile.

45. The poem's rhyme scheme exhibits all but

A) consonance.
B) eye rhyme.
C) feminine rhyme.
D) masculine rhyme.
E) true rhyme.

46. The poem's strength relies, in part, on "My heart keeps an open house" (line 3) and on "The deed will speak the truth" (line 14); both are examples of

A) apostrophe.
B) irony.
C) metaphor.
D) personification.
E) synecdoche.

47. Line 10, "With nakedness my shield," is essentially a(n)

A) oxymoron.
B) paradox.
C) pun.
D) syllepsis.
E) zeugma.

48. The idea that Roethke expresses in his poem relies on a comparison involving, as the title suggests, a house; this comparison constitutes a(n)

A) allegory.
B) controlling image.
C) hyperbole.
D) pleonasm.
E) simile.

49. The opening of the house, the doors being "widely swung" (line 3), serves as an invitation to

A) accept the persona's nakedness.
B) discover what the persona is guilty of.
C) explore the complexity that is the persona.
D) identify with the persona.
E) know all the persona's secrets.

50. The "lying mouth" (line 16) cannot speak the truth as well as does "the deed" because the mouth is controlled by the persona's

A) emotions.
B) epical eyes.
C) house.
D) language.
E) naked bones.

Part 3: Ability in Literary Criticism
15 items (2 points each)

Items 51-54 refer to Elizabeth Bishop's

One Art

The art of losing isn't hard to master;
so many things seem filled with the intent
to be lost that their loss is no disaster.

Lose something every day. Accept the fluster
of lost door keys, the hour badly spent.
The art of losing isn't hard to master.

Then practice losing farther, losing faster:
places, and names, and where it was you meant
to travel. None of these will bring disaster.

I lost my mother's watch. And look! my last, or
next-to-last, of three beloved houses went.
The art of losing isn't hard to master.

I lost two cities, lovely ones. And, vaster,
some realms I owned, two rivers, a continent.
I miss them, but it wasn't a disaster.

—Even losing you (the joking voice, a gesture
I love) I shan't have lied. It's evident
the art of losing's not too hard to master
though it may look like (*Write* it!) a disaster.

51. The poetic form of Elizabeth Bishop's "One Art" is

A) curtal sonnet.
B) rondeau.
C) *terza rima*.
D) triolet.
E) villanelle.

52. The poem's thematic concern, mastering the art of losing things, depends on a clever use of

A) ambiguity.
B) hyperbole.
C) meiosis.
D) paradox.
E) synecdoche.

53. The art of losing things, places, even people—especially, the mastery of this "art"—is, according to the poem, a natural consequence of

A) art.
B) disasters.
C) getting good at something.
D) joking and gesturing.
E) relationships.

54. The persona's communication of a philosophical approach to life makes the poem

A) cavalier.
B) didactic.
C) epigrammatic.
D) formulaic.
E) galliambic.

Items 55-57 refer to Elizabeth Barrett Browning's

[What's this of death . . . ?]

What's this of death, from you who never will die?
Think you the wrist that fashioned you in clay,
The thumb that set the hollow just that way
In your full throat and lidded the long eye
So roundly from the forehead, will let lie
Broken, forgotten, under foot some day
Your unimpeachable body, and so slay
The work he most had been remembered by?

I tell you this: whatever of dust to dust
Goes down, whatever of ashes may return
To its essential self in its own season,
Loveliness such as yours will not be lost,
But, cast in bronze upon his very urn,
Make known him Master, and for what good reason.

55. The poetic form of Barrett Browning's poem is

A) curtal sonnet.
B) English sonnet.
C) Italian sonnet.
D) Miltonic sonnet.
E) Spenserian sonnet.

56. Thematically, the persona is addressing the power that art has to

A) apostrophize.
B) hyperbolize.
C) immortalize.
D) mesmerize.
E) symbolize.

57. The first three lines of the poem's sestet include at least two

A) allusions.
B) clichés.
C) epiphanies.
D) puns.
E) vignettes.

Items 58-60 refer to Emily Brontë's

Hope

Hope was but a timid friend—
She sat without* the grated den, outside
Watching how my fate would tend
Even as selfish-hearted men. 4

She was cruel in her fear.
Through the bars, one dreary day,
I looked out to see her there
And she turned her face away! 8

Like a false guard false watch keeping
Still in strife she whispered peace;
She would sing while I was weeping,
If I listened, she would cease. 12

False she was, and unrelenting.
When my last joys strewed the ground,
Even Sorrow saw repenting,
Those sad relics scattered round; 16

Hope—whose whisper would have given
Balm to all my frenzied pain—
Stretched her wings, and soared to heaven;
Went—and ne'er returned again! 20

58. In Brontë's "Hope" the persona's disappointment is apparent in the simile found in stanza

A) five.
B) four.
C) one.
D) three.
E) two.

59. Brontë's treatment of Hope throughout the poem and Sorrow (line 15) constitutes

A) anthropomorphism.
B) kenosis.
C) mimesis.
D) reification.
E) synecdoche.

60. Ultimately, the tone of Brontë's lyric poem "Hope" is

A) combative.
B) optimistic.
C) pessimistic.
D) resigned.
E) sarcastic.

Items 61-65 refer to R. S. Thomas's

Lore

Job Davies, eighty-five
Winters old, and still alive
After the slow poison
And treachery of the seasons. 4

Miserable? Kick my arse!
It needs more than the rain's hearse,
Wind-drawn to pull me off
The great perch of my laugh. 8

What's living but courage?
Paunch full of hot porridge,
Nerves strengthened with tea,
Peat-black, dawn found me 12

Mowing where the grass grew,
Bearded with golden dew.
Rhythm of the long scythe
Kept this tall frame lithe. 16

What to do? Stay green.
Never mind the machine,
Whose fuel is human souls
Live large, man, and dream small. 20

61. The general thematic concern of R. S. Thomas's "Lore" is

A) farming.
B) laughing at the storms.
C) ludditism.
D) mowing after breakfast.
E) old age.

62. The tone of Davies's reply to the implied question concerning his life's having been tough is

A) bitterly indifferent.
B) candidly pessimistic.
C) cheerfully disillusioned.
D) defiantly prideful.
E) unapologetically haughty.

63. The poem's rhyme scheme is characterized by a balance between

A) assonance and dissonance.
B) consonance and true rhyme.
C) end rhyme and internal rhyme.
D) eye rhyme and true rhyme.
E) masculine rhyme and feminine rhyme.

64. The single occurrence of enjambment defines the relationship between stanzas

A) four and five.
B) one and two.
C) three and four.
D) two and three.
E) two through five.

65. Davies's first name, suggestive of patience and endurance, is a fine example of the

A) allonym.
B) ananym.
C) heteronym.
D) nominalism.
E) *rendende name*.

The required Tie-Breaking Essay prompt is found on the next page.

Part 4: Tie-Breaking Essay (required)

Note well: Contestants who do not write an essay will be disqualified even if they are not involved in any tie.

Note well: Any essay that does not demonstrate a sincere effort to discuss the assigned topic will be disqualified. The judge(s) should note carefully this criterion when breaking ties: ranking of essays for tie-breaking purposes should be based primarily on how well the topic has been addressed.

Three pages of blank paper have been provided for this essay; however, it is not expected that the essay will be longer than 150 words; however, the essay should reflect the *Handbook*'s notion that an essay is a "moderately brief discussion of a restricted topic": something more than a few sentences.

Read Wendell Berry's "The Peace of Wild Things" and Theodore Roethke's "'Long Live the Weeds,'" and offer a discussion of the poets' response to and reliance on the community of nature.

The Peace of Wild Things

When despair grows in me
and I wake in the middle of the night at the least sound
in fear of what my life and my children's lives may be,
I go and lie down where the wood drake*
rests in his beauty on the water, and the great heron feeds.
I come into the peace of wild things
who do not tax their lives with forethought
of grief. I come into the presence of still water.
And I feel above me the day-blind stars
waiting for their light. For a time
I rest in the grace of the world, and am free.

Wendell Berry
1968

*** a male Wood Duck, known for its striking color-pattern**

"Long Live the Weeds"
—Hopkins

Long live the weeds that overwhelm
My narrow vegetable realm!
The bitter rock, the barren soil
That force the son of man to toil;
All things unholy, marred by curse,
The ugly of the universe.
The rough, the wicked, and the wild
That keep the spirit undefiled.
With these I match my little wit
And earn the right to stand or sit,
Hope, look, create, or drink and die:
These shape the creature that is I.

Theodore Roethke
1941

2nd _____ _____

1st _____ _____
score initials

University Interscholastic League
Literary Criticism Contest

ANSWER SHEET

Contestant # _____ Conference # _____

Please write answers as CAPITAL letters.

Part 1: Knowledge of Literary Terms and of Literary History **30 items (1 point each)**

1. _____	11. _____	21. _____
2. _____	12. _____	22. _____
3. _____	13. _____	23. _____
4. _____	14. _____	24. _____
5. _____	15. _____	25. _____
6. _____	16. _____	26. _____
7. _____	17. _____	27. _____
8. _____	18. _____	28. _____
9. _____	19. _____	29. _____
10. _____	20. _____	30. _____

number correct _____ x 1 pt each = _____

Part 2: UIL Reading List **20 items (2 points each)**

31. _____	38. _____	45. _____
32. _____	39. _____	46. _____
33. _____	40. _____	47. _____
34. _____	41. _____	48. _____
35. _____	42. _____	49. _____
36. _____	43. _____	50. _____
37. _____	44. _____	

number correct _____ x 2 pts each = _____

Part 3: Ability in Literary Criticism **15 items (2 points each)**

51. _____	56. _____	61. _____
52. _____	57. _____	62. _____
53. _____	58. _____	63. _____
54. _____	59. _____	64. _____
55. _____	60. _____	65. _____

number correct _____ x 2 pts each = _____

total points

University Interscholastic League
Literary Criticism Contest
District 1 • 2011
KEY

Page numbers are those associated with the *Handbook* 11e, the Penguin 1996 edition of *P&P*, and the Vintage edition of *The Hairy Ape*.

Part 1: Knowledge of Literary Terms and of Literary History — **30 items (1 point each)**

1.	B		11.	D	422	21.	B	218
2.	B	4	12.	E	594	22.	D	464
3.	A		13.	D	404	23.	D	323
4.	E	567	14.	E	660	24.	A	10
5.	C	259	15.	E	522	25.	B	663
6.	A	231	16.	A	351	26.	A	70
7.	D	556	17.	D	392	27.	C	214
8.	B	665	18.	C	344	28.	C	241
9.	B	97	19.	C	339	29.	A	623
10.	B	665	20.	E	658	30.	E	489

Part 2: UIL Reading List — **20 items (2 points each)**

31.	C	147	38.	C	338	45.	C	215
32.	D	184	39.	C		46.	D	389
33.	A	174	40.	E	261	47.	B	376
34.	C	156	41.	D	143	48.	B	321
35.	B	166	42.	A	28	49.	C	
36.	A	194	43.	A	162	50.	A	
37.	C	69	44.	C	344			

Part 3: Ability in Literary Criticism — **15 items (2 points each)**

51.	E	576	56.	C		61.	E	
52.	D	398	57.	A	15	62.	D	
53.	E		58.	D		63.	B	119/149
54.	B	163	59.	D	465	64.	C	
55.	C	300	60.	D		65.	E	462

Part 4: Tie-Breaking Essay

These notes are not intended to be understood as a key for the Tie-Breaking Essay prompt; rather, they should serve the judge(s) as a presentation of critical ideas that might appear in an essay responding to the prompt.

Criteria for judging the Tie-Breaking Essay **SHOULD** include

the degree to which the instructions have been followed,

the quality of the critical insight offered in response to the selection,

the overall effectiveness of the written discussion, and

the grammatical correctness of the essay.

Note well that the quality of the contestant's critical insight is more important than the contestant's prose style. In short, the Literary Criticism contest is one that promotes the critical analysis of literature. The quality of the writing, which should never go unappreciated, does not trump evidence of critical analysis.

Critical Notes on Berry's "The Peace of Wild Things" and Roethke's "'Long Live the Weeds'"

Literary concepts that MIGHT be used by the contestant in a discussion of these poems include

alliteration,
contrast,
diction,
imagery,
meter,
sigmatism,
style,
theme, and
tone.

The contestant has been asked to discuss each poet's response to nature, especially in terms of his reliance on nature as community—to which, the contestant should perceive, the personas feel themselves intimately connected.

The contestant might note that while Berry's persona turns to nature upon feeling despair, Roethke's persona begins with a praising of nature—an all-inclusive praising that enumerates the weeds, the rocks, the rough, the wicked. His or her essay might dwell on this contrast: Berry's turning to beauty for solace "for a time" and Roethke's recognizing the not-so-beautiful as kindred and as something that he wishes will give him shape.

The young writer might focus on Berry's explicit imagery and Roethke's simple diction, which are curiously matched with Berry's free verse and Roethke's formal meter and rhyme. The need for solace or succor sends Berry's persona looking for the unbound and varied beauty of nature, and Roethke's persona desires to earn a participatory union with the foundational elements, the bitter rock and barren soil, of nature. Though the needs and the approaches differ, each persona turns to nature as an outsider looking for communion.

A contestant who has been engaged in literary analysis for some time might recognize in Roethke's paradox, "The ugly of the universe. / [. . .] / That keep[s] the spirit undefiled," something of the Mariner's blessing of the water-serpents in Coleridge's "Rime." He or she might see in Berry's "peace of wild things / who do not tax their lives with fore-thought / of grief" something of Robert Burns's contemplation of the mouse and her not guessing that her best laid plans might go awry. His or her discussion might focus on man's long-recognized turning to nature for comfort.